VIVA

Every assessment should provide evidence of learning that the student could explain and defend.

VIVA is an optional reference for asking whether an assessment provides credible and proportionate evidence of the student's own learning, judgement and responsibility. It supports, and does not replace, the University policy, local guidance or approval processes.

ASSESSMENT-DESIGN PRINCIPLE

Make student learning and judgement visible.

The central question is not simply "Did AI write this?" but whether the assessment provides credible evidence that the student can reach a reasoned conclusion and explain, defend and apply it.

Validity is the overarching judgement: whether the evidence supports the intended interpretation and use. Inclusion, visibility and accountability help make that judgement defensible when AI is available.

V
Valid

The assessment supports a defensible judgement about the intended learning.

Define what students should know, do or judge. Align the task, conditions, evidence and approved marking criteria so that success reflects the intended capability rather than AI substitution or other irrelevant advantages.

I
Inclusive

The assessment is equitable, accessible and proportionate.

Provide equal baseline access to permitted tools. Consider disability, language, cost, digital confidence, reasonable adjustments, workload and any oral or process evidence.

V
Visible

The student's own reasoning and decisions can be seen.

Use application, drafts, annotations, source verification, process records, explanation or structured questioning where proportionate. Visibility does not require a viva voce.

A
Accountable

Permissions, responsibilities and AI use are explicit.

State what is permitted, required and excluded. Specify any declaration. Students remain responsible for accuracy, evidence, sources, ethics and the final submission.

Could the student explain and defend the work?

AI may assist in producing an answer. The assessment should still provide proportionate evidence of the student's own understanding and judgement under the conditions set for the task. Look for that evidence through critique, defence, application and reflection on decisions. If it is weak, consider strengthening the task or what students must show; if it is sufficient, the assessment can stay as it is.

Triangulate evidence where necessary

Where AI could materially obscure the capability being assessed, draw on more than one proportionate source of evidence, such as the submitted work together with staged drafts, explanation or dialogue. Triangulation strengthens the judgement; no single component proves authorship.

Important qualification

VIVA does not mean every assessment needs a viva voce. It means every assessment should provide credible and proportionate evidence of the student's own learning, judgement and responsibility. It is one optional way of structuring that question.

Grounding

Written to be consistent with the University policy on AI use in summative assessment (www.ox.ac.uk/about/how-we-are-run/policies-and-statements/policy-hub/ai-use-in-summative-assessment). It is not University policy and has not been formally endorsed. Follow applicable divisional, departmental, programme and reasonable-adjustment requirements.